before the sessions court in Delhi, namely that when we think of a revolution ‘it is not the cult of the bomb and the pistol’.

The question whether Bhagat Singh was a terrorist is significant for two reasons. First, it is important that we know what Bhagat Singh stood for. Otherwise, we fail to understand him properly. Bhagat Singh himself was always at pains to ensure that he was never misunderstood, whether in terms of his words or his actions. Second, at a time today when issues of terrorism, public safety and national security are so inextricably intertwined all over the world, it is important to be clear what his espousal of violence or revolution meant. Political action can sometimes involve violence. Violence is regrettably part of that normal historical process. When this happens, political and military discourse sometimes wrongly envisions this as a conflagration of impending apocalyptic wars. In the early years of the twentieth century, the unstable world of Empire in India after the First World War led to a perception of a nebulous threat to peace and order waiting to engulf everyone. More recently, we are reminded by the Australian judge in the case of *Singh*[11] of how there is no antithesis between violent retribution and political action when a policeman is killed as an act of revenge.

An Indian citizen, a Mr Singh, of Sikh ethnicity, had in India been involved with the Khalistan Liberation Force (the KLF), an organization that sought the creation of an independent Sikh state and that used violence to achieve this objective. His role in the KLF was to collect information on their behalf. The KLF used this information when it decided to kill people. Indeed, Mr Singh had assisted in the provision of weapons that were used by the KLF to carry out acts of violence. Mr Singh then murdered a police officer which was described by the Australian High Court judge as ‘the most violent of crimes’, and not least because the ‘crime was committed out of a strong, if not exclusively retributive motivation’.[12] In relation to the killing of the police officer in Ludhiana, Mr Singh had a significant political purpose. Such a purpose was not negatived by the element of revenge because revenge is likely to be an aspect of many political crimes. It was not negatived, moreover, by looking simply at the main political objective